

# Oppo Reno 12 Pro

Perseverance over performance

**T**he Oppo Reno series of smartphones doesn't make sense. But well, that isn't something that is driving the industry. See, for a techie like myself, every smartphone or gadget goes through very critical eyes. With the Oppo Reno series, I have always had that critical eye, apart from the Digit tests that give a very clear, objective picture of each device being good or not. But this time around, let's try a little pit of perception change.

While I can't go away from our guidelines of the stringent test that every smartphone goes through in the Digit Test Lab, I will try and not let that influence my complete verdict decision this time around (I know my friends at Oppo will be happy to read this). So this time, I will take a look at the Oppo Reno 12 Pro's design, display, performance, camera and battery like I always do, but with a bit of a wider perspective and not through my enthusiast lens. Let's go.

## DESIGN

So as always, I'll start with the design. Now, here we have a lot going on. The Oppo Reno 12 Pro comes in two colour options - the Rose gold and the Black. I got the rose gold colour for my review and while the colour does look premium, there is too much going on with the design.

We are getting three different kinds of finishes. There is the shimmery matte plastic back panel, with the gloss strip towards the bottom holding the Oppo branding. Below the strip, there is a glass-like texture at the back which does catch fingerprints and smudges. And while the colour is a very decent shade of copper or rose gold, this is still too much bling for a person like myself.

While the back panel I'm not a big fan of (except the colour), the front of



the Oppo Reno 12 Pro looks really good. Yes, while it is nothing but a hole-punch quad-curved display, it looks really good. We are getting the premiumness of a curved display, without the accidental touches. This curves from all four sides, which gives the display a bit of a 'floating look' that is very nice if you look at it closely from the sides.

Furthermore, the weight of the Oppo Reno 12 Pro is very light. The smartphone weighs just 180 grams, making it very comfortable to hold for longer durations. Apart from that, we are also getting IP65 dust and water resistance, and Corning Gorilla Glass Victus protection from scratches.

So overall, the design is good. I like that Oppo is still experimenting with the back panel finishes for one of its most important product. With me, this may not have worked this time around since I like things to be more basic, but I'm sure there will be many takers for this three-finish back panel.

Furthermore, we are getting a very nice front panel along with durability features as well.

## DISPLAY

Now, in terms of the display, we are getting a nice 6.7-inch FHD+ AMOLED display along with a 120Hz refresh rate and HDR10+. Now, looking at the display, it feels really good. The colour are punchy and vibrant, and this AMOLED panel also looks super sharp. Furthermore, we are getting a 120Hz refresh rate which makes the experience all the more smooth.

However, this display doesn't represent colours very accurately. I tested the colour accuracy using the Calman colorchecker and here, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro showcased an average DeltaE of above 3 points. This means that the colours aren't represented accurately and this is a very saturated display. An average DeltaE of under 3 is considered good for smartphones.

In the Greyscale test, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro again showcased similar results. The whites are all over the place, and the reds are blown up a bit too much, which is why we see more saturated colors on the Oppo Reno 12 Pro.

Coming to the brightness, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro showcased a maximum luminance of 966 nits under bright sunlight, which is very good. Now, you must be thinking, "but the brightness as mentioned is 1200 nits?" Well, you're right. But the peak brightness of a smartphone is basically the brightest one percent or the brightest pixel of a whole display, so the real world numbers will always be lower.

So yes, this is not categorically a good display. It checks all the boxes, but the colours are all over the place. But well, that is only for testing purposes, because with the naked eye, this will look like a very good display. Furthermore, most people prefer punchy and bright colours on their smartphones so this is not a deal breaker for Oppo. Rest of the things like brightness, sharpness, and responsiveness are all on point.